

SPORTING AND HUNTING FIREARMS

In this period, as previously, hunters required firearms of differing natures for different environments and types of game. A small-caliber repeating rifle firing a revolver cartridge might have been ideal for some circumstances, such as hunting small game, but a heavy-caliber rifle firing powerful cartridges was essential when dealing with large, dangerous animals such as rhinos or elephants. While a higher rate of fire made lever-action guns popular for sporting and hunting, bolt-action weapons were more robust and reliable, and easier to maintain.



▲ WINCHESTER MODEL 1873 SPORTING RIFLE

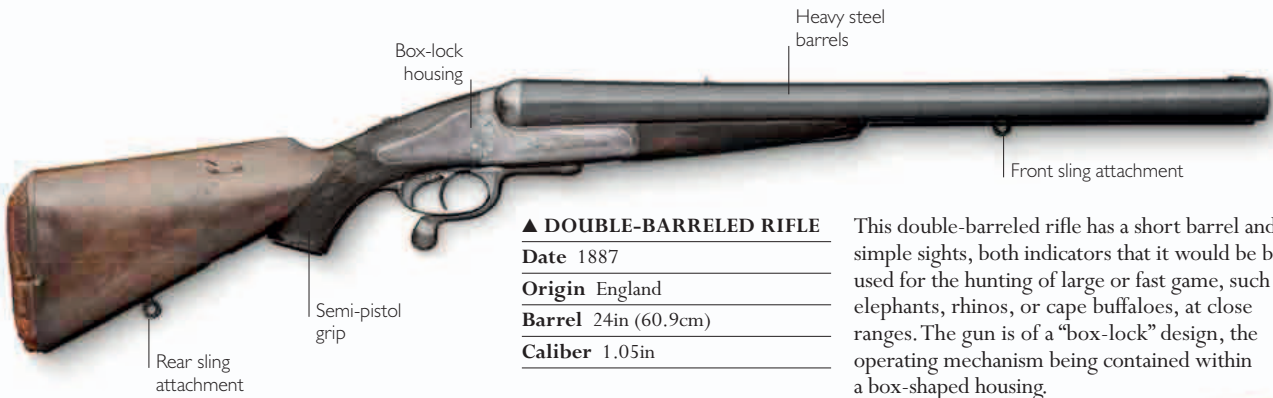
Date 1885

Origin US

Barrel 23½in (60cm)

Caliber .44in-40

The Model 1873 was the first repeating rifle of its type to be widely used throughout the world. It was chambered for cartridges of sufficient strength for hunting medium-size game, such as deer. It was favored by hunters in North America, Africa, and India.



▲ DOUBLE-BARRELED RIFLE

Date 1887

Origin England

Barrel 24in (60.9cm)

Caliber 1.05in

This double-barreled rifle has a short barrel and simple sights, both indicators that it would be best used for the hunting of large or fast game, such as elephants, rhinos, or cape buffaloes, at close ranges. The gun is of a “box-lock” design, the operating mechanism being contained within a box-shaped housing.



▲ GIBBS-FARQUHARSON RIFLE

Date c.1890

Origin UK

Barrel 25in (63.5cm)

Caliber .22in Hornet

This rifle was made for famous hunter F. C. Selous in .400in/.450in caliber. The grip is fitted with steel plates, a customization requested by Selous to strengthen the gun. The original barrel has been replaced by one made to take a .22in-caliber Hornet round. Despite this small caliber, the velocity of the bullet was ideal for shooting game such as deer.